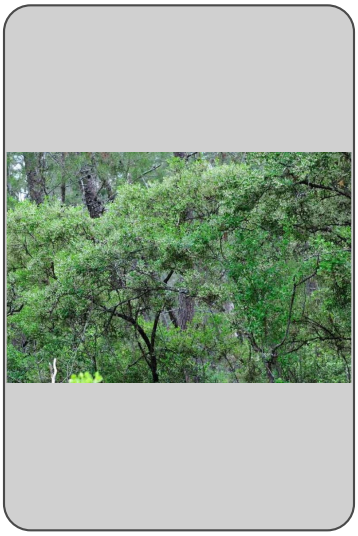
Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Vaccinium arboreum ‘Persistence’

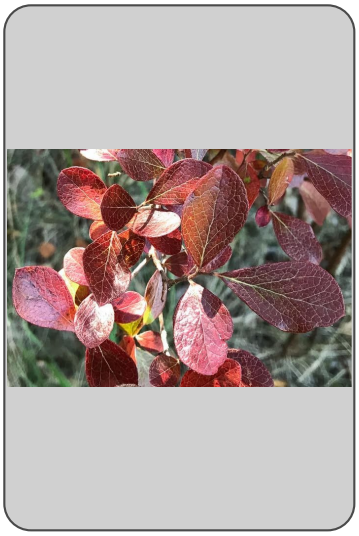
Persistence Sparkleberry

Family: Ericaceae

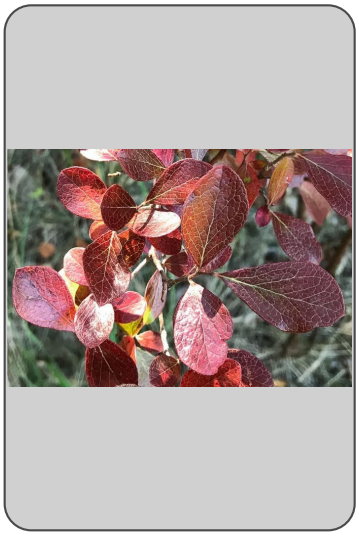
Passage: 4 | Rockery: 3 | **TOTAL 7**



HABIT



FALL



LEAF





FLOWER / FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous to semi-evergreen small tree or large shrub. Leaves glossy, leathery, elliptical, 1–3 in long. Fall color red to purplish in cooler years. Bark exfoliating, mottled gray-brown-red. White bell-shaped flowers in spring; shiny black berries persist into winter. Largest North American Vaccinium. Persistent winter fruit and attractive exfoliating bark. Cultivar-specific performance data limited; species characteristics used as proxy and labeled as such

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Species typically 10–20 ft tall (occasionally to 25 ft), 4–10 ft wide. Cultivar ‘Persistence’ follows species habit; no distinct size deviation stated in available

Sun

Water

Soil
Prefers well-drained sandy or rocky soils

Zone 8a
Species native to southeastern United States, Zones 6–9. Well suited to Atlanta Zone 8a. Semi-evergreen in the South

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Species native to southeastern and south-central United States. Cultivar ‘Persistence’ is a named selection; specific origin details not stated in primary

Form
Deciduous to semi-evergreen small tree or large shrub. Leaves glossy, leathery, elliptical, 1–3 in long. Fall color red to purplish in cooler years. Bark exfoliating, mottled gray-brown-red. White bell-shaped flowers in spring; shiny black berries persist into winter. Largest North American Vaccinium. Persistent winter fruit and attractive exfoliating bark. Cultivar-specific performance data limited; species characteristics used as proxy and labeled as such

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Siting
Not stated

Soil prep
Not stated

Depth & spacing
Not stated

Best planting season
Not stated

Establishment
Plant in full sun to light shade on well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established. Can be trained to single or multi-trunk form

HEALTH

Health
No serious problems stated for the species. Berries are dry and not highly palatable to humans but valued by wildlife

Symptoms
None stated